AWS Assignment

Amazon Simple Notification Service (SNS): Topic Creation and Email Subscription

Aim

To create an Amazon SNS topic and subscribe an email address to it, then confirm the subscription so that notifications published to the topic reach the subscriber.

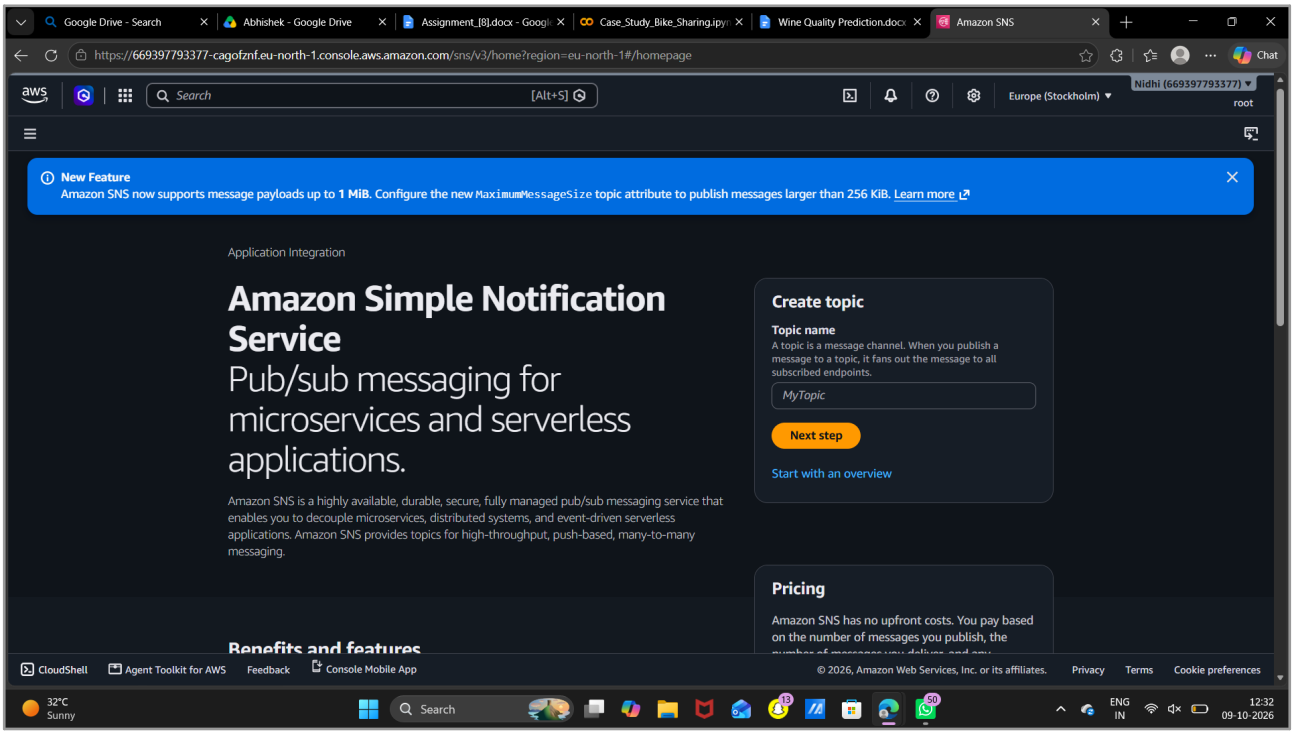
Requirements

- An AWS account with access to the AWS Management Console
- Amazon SNS service (region: Europe - Stockholm, eu-north-1)
- A valid email address (Gmail) to receive the subscription confirmation

Procedure (Contents)

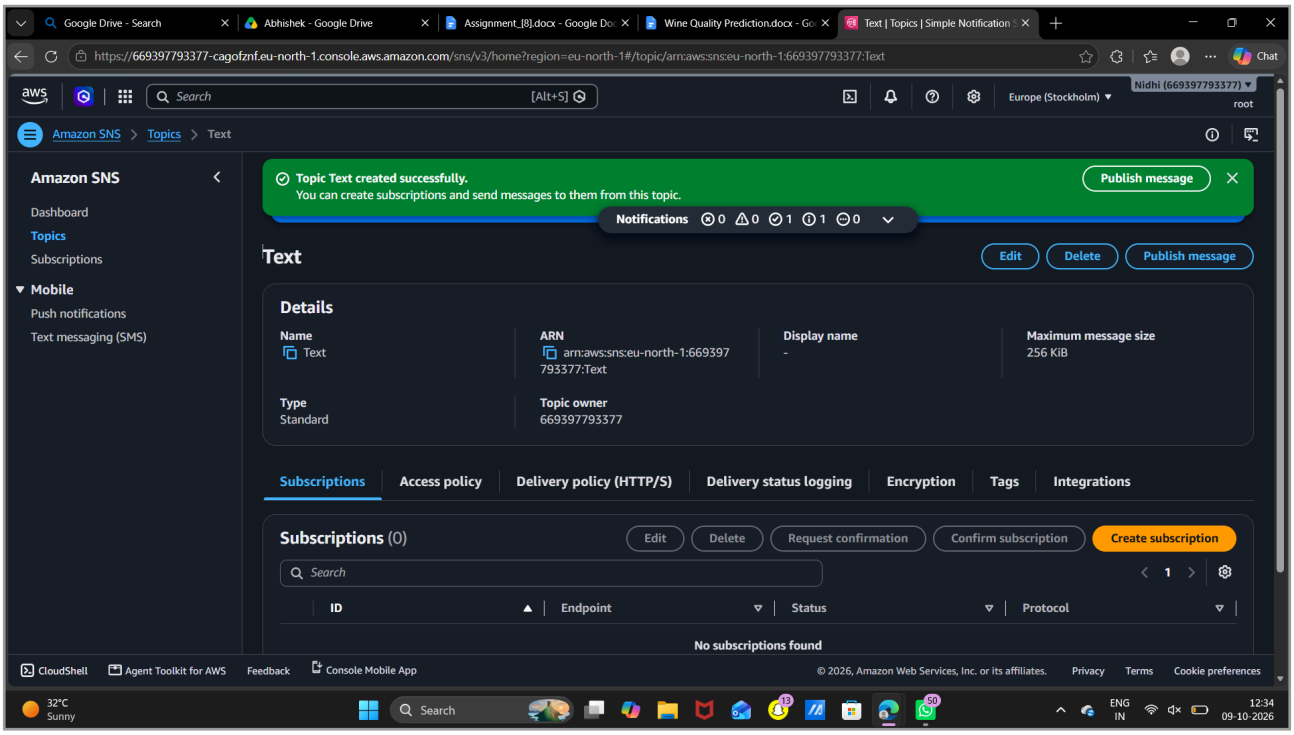
Step	Action
1	Open Amazon SNS and Create a Topic
2	Topic Created Successfully
3	Create Subscription
4	Subscription Created - Pending Confirmation
5	Open the Confirmation Email in Gmail
6	Confirm the Subscription

Step 1: Open Amazon SNS and Create a Topic



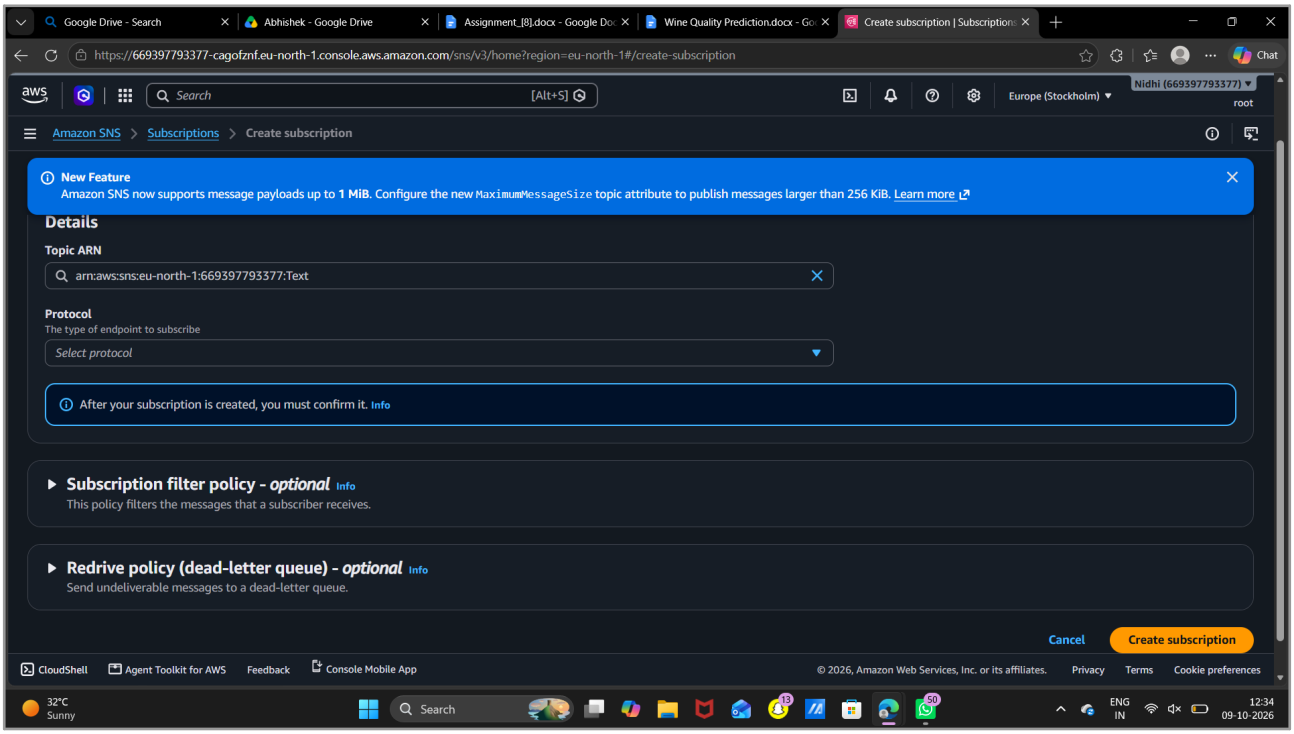
Log in to the AWS Management Console, select the region (Europe - Stockholm) and open Amazon Simple Notification Service. In the "Create topic" box, enter a topic name (here: **Text**) and click **Next step**.

Step 2: Topic Created Successfully



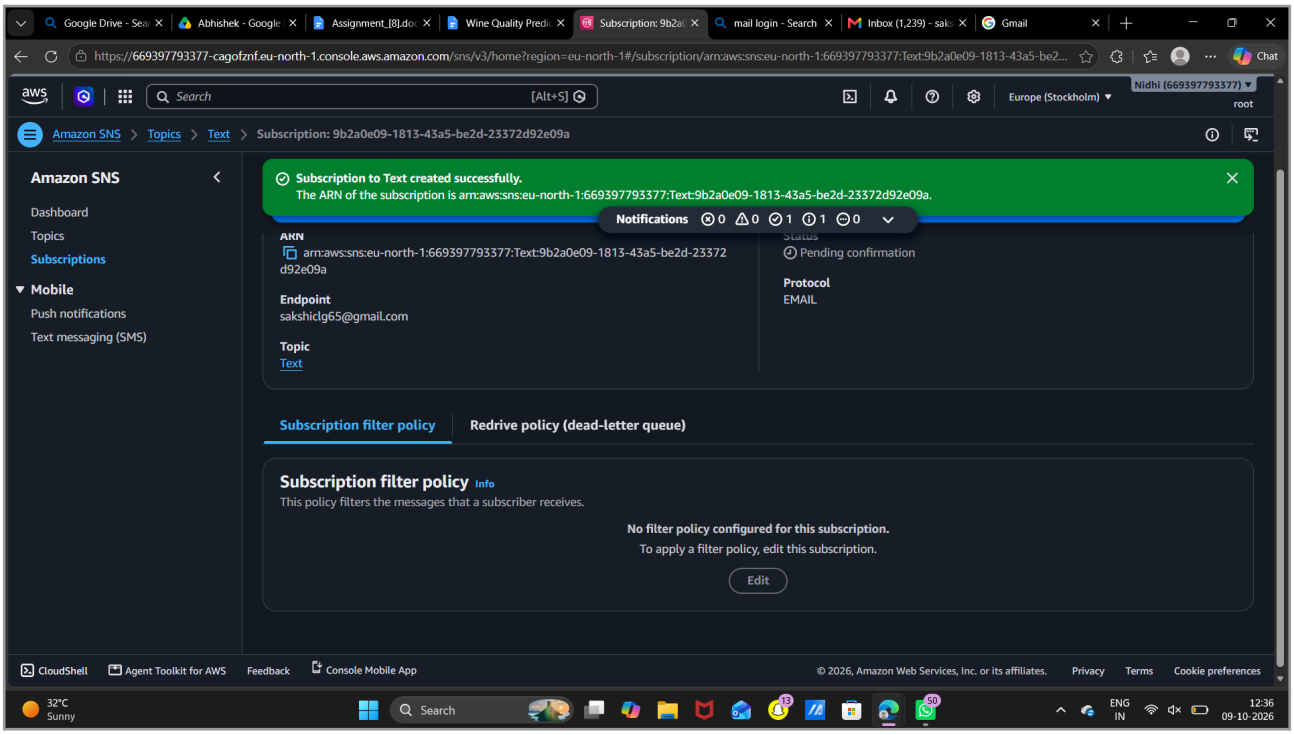
SNS shows the message "Topic Text created successfully". The topic details page displays the Name, ARN, Type (**Standard**) and Topic owner. Under the **Subscriptions** tab there are 0 subscriptions, so click **Create subscription**.

Step 3: Create Subscription



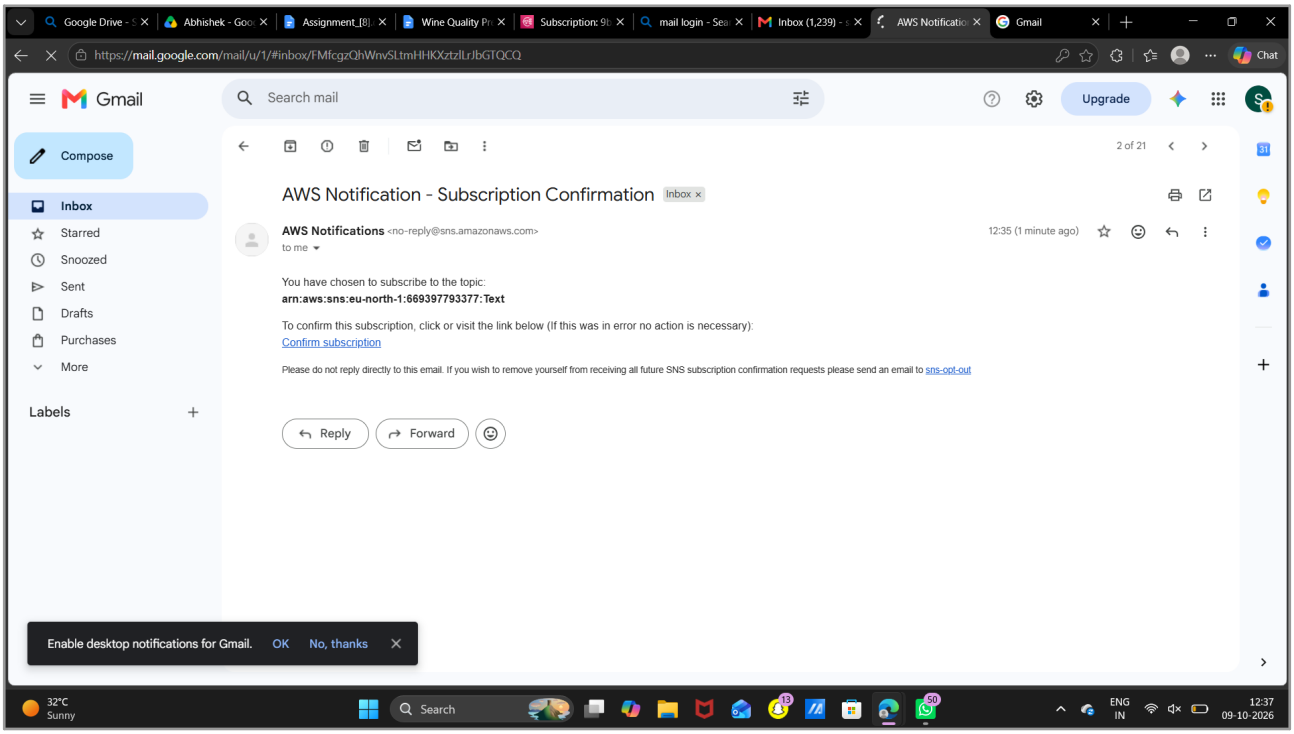
The Topic ARN is already filled in (arn:aws:sns:eu-north-1:...:Text). From the **Protocol** drop-down choose **Email**, enter the email address as the endpoint, and click **Create subscription**. Note: the subscription must be confirmed after it is created.

Step 4: Subscription Created - Pending Confirmation



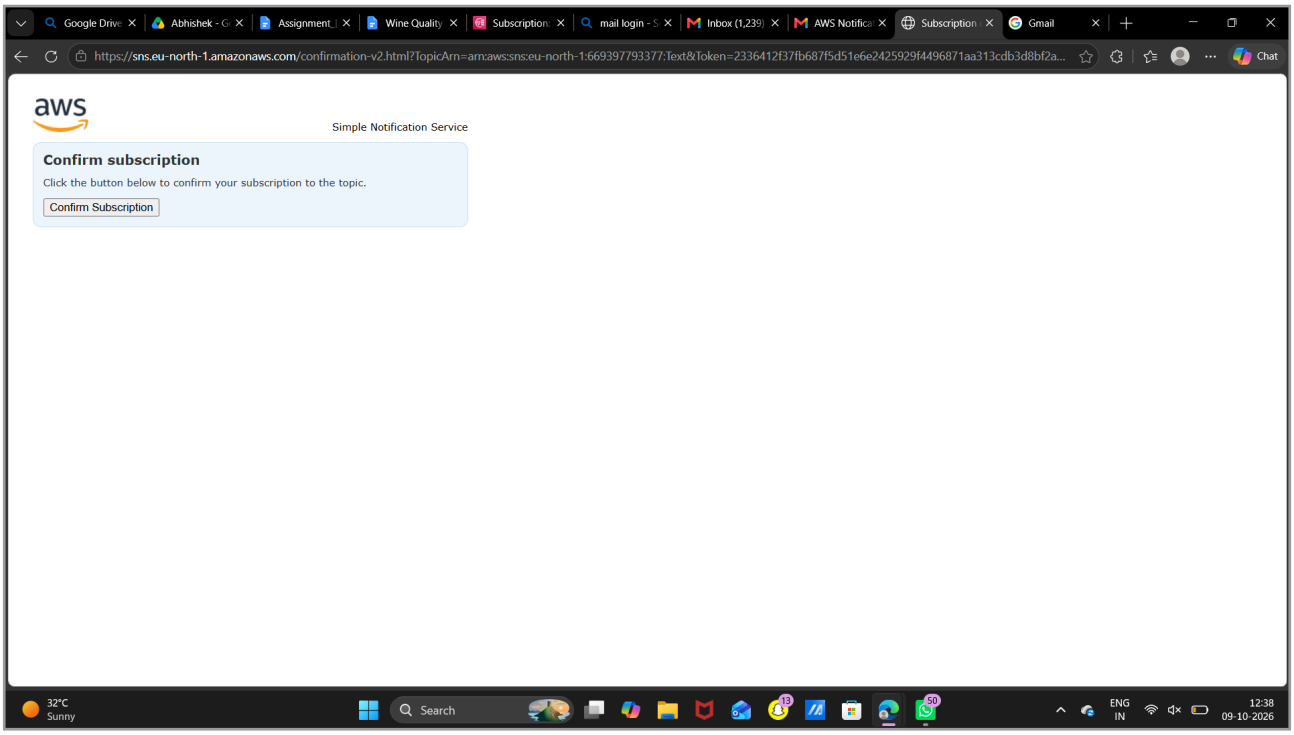
The message "Subscription to Text created successfully" appears. The details page shows the Protocol as **EMAIL**, the Endpoint (the subscriber's email) and the Status as **Pending confirmation**. AWS has now sent a confirmation email to that address.

Step 5: Open the Confirmation Email in Gmail



In the inbox, open the email "AWS Notification - Subscription Confirmation" sent by no-reply@sns.amazonaws.com. It says that you have chosen to subscribe to the topic. Click the **Confirm subscription** link in the email.

Step 6: Confirm the Subscription



The link opens the AWS "Confirm subscription" page. Click the **Confirm Subscription** button. After this the subscription status changes from Pending confirmation to **Confirmed** and the email address will start receiving messages published to the topic.

Summary of the Screenshots

Amazon Simple Notification Service (SNS) is a fully managed publish/subscribe messaging service. A **topic** acts as a message channel: when a message is published to the topic, SNS delivers it to every subscribed endpoint (email, SMS, HTTP/S, Lambda, SQS, etc.).

What was done in this exercise

- Opened Amazon SNS in the AWS console (region: Europe - Stockholm, eu-north-1) and created a **Standard** topic named **Text**.
- Created a subscription on that topic using the **Email** protocol with the subscriber's email address as the endpoint.
- The subscription showed **Pending confirmation**, because SNS requires the subscriber to opt in.
- Opened the "AWS Notification - Subscription Confirmation" email in Gmail and clicked **Confirm subscription**.
- Clicked the **Confirm Subscription** button on the AWS confirmation page to activate the subscription.

Key points

- An email subscription is not active until the recipient confirms it - this prevents unwanted emails.
- The topic ARN uniquely identifies the topic and is used when creating subscriptions.
- Once confirmed, any message sent with **Publish message** on the topic is delivered to the subscribed email.

Conclusion

An SNS topic was created and an email endpoint was successfully subscribed and confirmed. The topic is now ready to publish notifications to that email address.